



Non-Verbal Reasoning



The non-verbal reasoning test involves solving problems that are represented with pictures and diagrams. There are a number of different types of questions for the non-verbal reasoning test which could include:

- finding shapes that are like each other based on similarities (for example colours and number of sides);
- finding the odd one out in a group of pictures;
- identifying a shape which has been rotated;
- breaking the code in a sequence of images;
- spotting the missing shape in a sequence;
- identifying the nets of 3D shapes.



Here is an example of the type of question you may get in this section:



1. Which is the correct code for figure 4?

 M B	 R B	 M Q	 ?
1	2	3	4

B	Q	B	R
Y	M	Q	Q
A	B	C	D

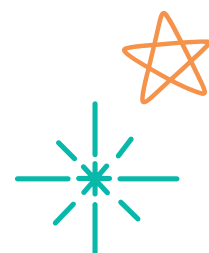


The answer would be D. The letter common to the first two shapes is B which represents the cross-hatching pattern they both have. Therefore Q represents the solid orange colour. The M is the letter representing the shape of the moon and it comes at the top of the box. Therefore the answer is D (R to represent the irregular dodecagon and the Q at the bottom to represent the solid orange colour).

The non-verbal reasoning test, for many children, can be very intimidating. The best way to prepare for this is through practice. Complete many different type of practice non-verbal reasoning tests with your child and discuss how each question is solved. This will give your child the experience needed to tackle the on-verbal reasoning tests.



For a thorough guide to all aspects of the 11+ test, try our [Survival Guide for Parents/Carers](#).



11+ Non-Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper

Break the Code

Codes are systems of **words**, **numbers** or **figures** that are used to represent others. **Break the Code** activities are fun, but can be difficult to solve.

The pictures in the boxes have been given letter codes. Each letter describes a different aspect of the picture's appearance. Once you have solved the code, you can use it to work out the answer for the code in the final box.

For example:

Which code should be placed in the final box?

 P S	 R S	 P Q	 ?
1	2	3	4

R	P	W	R
Q	S	Q	S
A	B	C	D

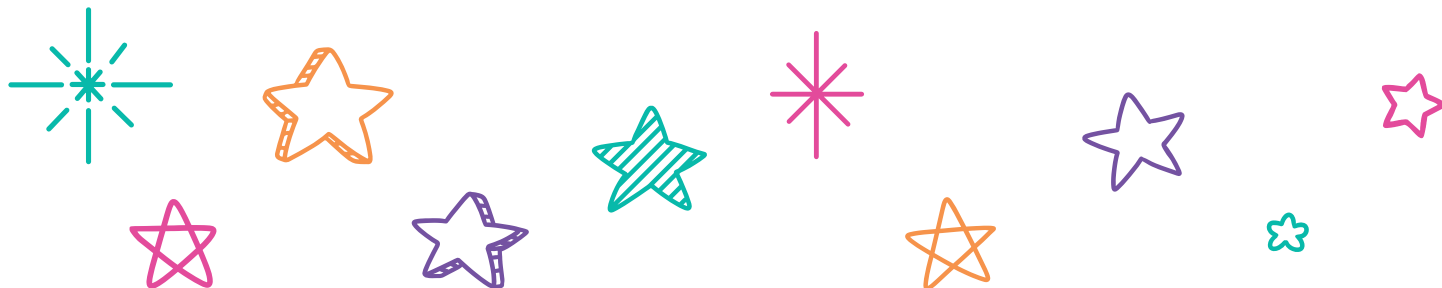
The correct answer is **A**. The two characteristics of figure 1 are that:

- it is a square
- it is orange

Looking at the other figures, we can see that figure 2 is also orange. It also has an S in the code, as does figure 1. This means that S = orange. The bottom letter refers to the colour or pattern of the figure.

We can see that figure 3 is also a square. It has the letter P in the code, as does figure 1. This means that P = square. The top letter refers to the shape in the figure.

This means that Q = vertical stripes. Therefore, the answer for figure 4 is A because R = arrow and Q = vertical stripes.



11+ Non-Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper

Break the Code: Test 1

Which is the correct code for figure 4?

1.

 A C	 A Q	 U C	 ?
1	2	3	4

Q	U	A	U
U	Q	U	A
A	B	C	D

answer

2.

 Y W	 Y H	 G W	 ?
1	2	3	4

W	Z	G	H
Y	H	H	G
A	B	C	D

answer

3.

 D P	 S G	 D G	 ?
1	2	3	4

S	P	D	G
P	S	G	S
A	B	C	D

answer

4.

 M B	 R B	 M Q	 ?
1	2	3	4

B	Q	B	R
Y	M	Q	Q
A	B	C	D

answer

5.

 F D	 F S	 T D	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	T	F	S
F	S	Q	T
A	B	C	D

answer

6.

 S U	 S C	 H U	 ?
1	2	3	4

H	C	H	S
C	H	U	Q
A	B	C	D

answer

7.

 H S	 C S	 H G	 ?
1	2	3	4

R	H	G	C
G	C	S	G
A	B	C	D

answer

8.

 L T	 L S	 H T	 ?
1	2	3	4

L	H	S	T
H	S	H	H
A	B	C	D

answer



11+ Non-Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper:

Break the Code: Test 1 Answers

1.

 A C	 A Q	 U C	 ?
1	2	3	4

Q	U	A	U
U	Q	U	A
A	B	C	D

answer

B

The top letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. A = orange and U = chequered.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. C = smile and Q = heart.

2.

 Y W	 Y H	 G W	 ?
1	2	3	4

W	Z	G	H
Y	H	H	G
A	B	C	D

answer

C

The top letter of the code represents the colour. Y = purple and G = white.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. W = arrows and H = pentagon.

3.

 D P	 S G	 D G	 ?
1	2	3	4

S	P	D	G
P	S	G	S
A	B	C	D

answer

A

The top letter of the code represents the shape. D = triangle and S = circle.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. P = dots and G = purple.

4.

 M B	 R B	 M Q	 ?
1	2	3	4

B	Q	B	R
Y	M	Q	Q
A	B	C	D

answer

D

The top letter of the code represents the shape. M = moon and R = cross.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. B = chequered and Q = purple.

5.

 F D	 F S	 T D	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	T	F	S
F	S	Q	T
A	B	C	D

answer

B

The top letter of the code represents the shape. F = circle and T = triangle.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. D = diamonds and S = stripes.

6.

 S U	 S C	 H U	 ?
1	2	3	4

H	C	H	S
C	H	U	Q
A	B	C	D

answer

A

The top letter of the code represents the shape. S = diamond and H = star.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. U = dots and C = chequered.

7.

 H S	 C S	 H G	 ?
1	2	3	4

R	H	G	C
G	C	S	G
A	B	C	D

answer

D

The top letter of the code represents the shape. H = hexagon and C = circle.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. S = dots and G = purple.

8.

 L T	 L S	 H T	 ?
1	2	3	4

L	H	S	T
H	S	H	H
A	B	C	D

answer

B

The top letter of the code represents the shape. L = standard triangle and H = upside-down triangle.

The bottom letter of the code represents the orientation of the lines. T = horizontal and S = vertical.

11+ Non-Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper

Break the Code: Test 2

Which is the correct code for figure 4?

1.

 A B	 O B	 A G	 ?
1	2	3	4

O	A	B	G
G	B	A	B
A	B	C	D

answer

2.

 H R	 H L	 D R	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	H	D	Q
R	L	L	B
A	B	C	D

answer

3.

 T L	 O L	 T H	 ?
1	2	3	4

O	O	L	L
B	H	O	T
A	B	C	D

answer

4.

 R F	 R T	 H F	 ?
1	2	3	4

F	T	G	H
T	H	F	T
A	B	C	D

answer

5.

 D S	 Y T	 Y S	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	Y	D	S
F	D	T	T
A	B	C	D

answer

6.

 S N	 S G	 D N	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	N	G	S
G	G	U	N
A	B	C	D

answer

7.

 C L	 V H	 V L	 ?
1	2	3	4

L	C	H	H
C	H	V	C
A	B	C	D

answer

8.

 K B	 R M	 R B	 ?
1	2	3	4

K	M	R	M
M	B	M	K
A	B	C	D

answer



11+ Non-Verbal Reasoning Practice Paper:

Break the Code: Test 2 Answers

1.

	A B		O B		A G		?
1		2		3		4	

O	A	B	G
G	B	A	B
A	B	C	D

answer

A

The top letter of the code represents the colour. A = purple and O = white.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. B = ring and G = curve.

2.

	H R		H L		D R		?
1		2		3		4	

D	H	D	Q
R	L	L	B
A	B	C	D

answer

C

The top letter of the code represents the pattern. H = stripes and D = dots.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. R = curved cross and L = heart.

3.

	T L		O L		T H		?
1		2		3		4	

O	O	L	L
B	H	O	T
A	B	C	D

answer

B

The top letter of the code represents the shape. T = triangles and O = octagon.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. L = purple and H = stripes.

4.

 R F	 R T	 H F	 ?
1	2	3	4

F	T	G	H
T	H	F	T
A	B	C	D

answer

D

The top letter of the code represents the shape. R = quadrilateral and H = smile.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour. F = white and T = purple.

5.

 D S	 Y T	 Y S	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	Y	D	S
F	D	T	T
A	B	C	D

answer

C

The top letter of the code represents the colour or pattern. D = dots and Y = orange.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. S = star and T = triangle.

6.

 S N	 S G	 D N	 ?
1	2	3	4

D	N	G	S
G	G	U	N
A	B	C	D

answer

A

The top letter of the code represents the shape. S = star and D = diamond.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour. N = purple and G = orange.

7.

 C L	 V H	 V L	 ?
1	2	3	4

L	C	H	H
C	H	V	C
A	B	C	D

answer

B

The top letter of the code represents the pattern. C = chequered and V = stripes.

The bottom letter of the code represents the shape. L = arrow and H = heart.

8.

 K B	 R M	 R B	 ?
1	2	3	4

K	M	R	M
M	B	M	K
A	B	C	D

answer

A

The top letter of the code represents the shape. K = hexagon and R = ring.

The bottom letter of the code represents the colour. B = orange and M = white.